PA#1 — Proposal and planning · rubric

CSC13114 · project milestone, teams of up to 3 · 4% of the course · 100 points
Hand in two pages plus your repository link. **No specification in this milestone** — the spec is IA#1 and, for your core feature, a later project milestone.

What is scored

#	Criterion	Points
1	Problem and users	20
2	The LLM feature, and the cost of it being wrong	25
3	Scope: in and out	15
4	Plan and ownership	20
5	Risks	10
6	Technology choices	10

1. Problem and users — 20 points

Points	What it looks like
17–20	A named user in a named situation, and one problem stated in a sentence. You can say what they do today instead.
11–16	The user is a category ("restaurant staff"); the problem is real but broad.
4–10	A product description with no user in it.
0–3	Missing.

2. The LLM feature and the cost of being wrong — 25 points

Points	What it looks like
21–25	One feature, described concretely, where a wrong answer has a cost you can name — who is affected, how much, and whether it can be undone.

Points	What it looks like
13–20	A real feature, but the consequence of a wrong answer is stated in general terms.
5–12	A chatbot bolted onto the corner of the product.
0–4	No LLM feature, or one that cannot be wrong in any interesting way.

A feature where being wrong costs nothing will also score badly in PA#4 later, when you have to evaluate it. Choose one where you can answer: *who is harmed, and how would we know?*

3. Scope — 15 points

Points	What it looks like
13–15	What is in for this semester, and an explicit list of what you are leaving out. The two lists are consistent with the plan.
8–12	In-scope is clear; out-of-scope is implied.
3–7	A feature wish list.
0–2	Missing.

4. Plan and ownership — 20 points

Points	What it looks like
17–20	Each of the six checkpoints has work assigned, with a named owner and a date. The plan is compatible with the course calendar.
11–16	A plan with dates, but ownership is "the team".
4–10	A list of phases with no dates.
0–3	Missing.

5. Risks — 10 points

Points	What it looks like
9–10	Two risks that would actually sink this project, each with a mitigation you could start this week.
5–8	Generic risks ("time pressure") with generic

Points	What it looks like
	mitigations.
1–4	One line.
0	Missing.

6. Technology choices — 10 points

Points	What it looks like
9–10	Each choice has one line of justification tied to this project, including the model provider and what it costs.
5–8	Choices listed, justification generic.
1–4	A stack list.
0	Missing.

How to submit

One zip file, named after your student ID **and the total you give yourself**:

- individual work — <StudentID>_<total>.zip, for example 23120001_82.zip
- group work — <StudentID1>-<StudentID2>-<StudentID3>_<total>.zip, IDs in ascending order, for example 23120001-23120042-23120117_75.zip

The zip must contain **SELF_ASSESSMENT_REPORT.md**: one row per criterion in this rubric, the marks you claim, and evidence pointing at a file, a section, a commit or a test name — plus a short *what I did not manage*. The total in that table is the number in the file name. Template on Classroom.
A wrong file name costs no marks but delays your result — the grading script matches submissions to the class list by that name.

Honesty adjustment

Your self-assessment is compared with the mark you actually earn. The gap is your total − the mark, on the same 100-point scale.

Gap	Adjustment
within ±10	none — this is normal calibration
+11 to +20	−3
+21 to +30	−6
more than +30	−10
−21 or worse	−3 — read the rubric before you score yourself down

Gap	Adjustment
no SELF_ASSESSMENT_REPORT.md	−10, and the file-name total is ignored

A criterion you claim with no evidence line counts as claimed-and-not-done for this comparison. The adjustment never takes a submission below 0.
Scoring yourself honestly low costs you nothing inside ±10. Claiming marks you did not earn costs more than the marks would have been worth.

Notes

- Two pages is a limit, not a target.
- Ambition is not scored. A small product with a sharp LLM feature scores higher than a large product with a vague one.
- You may change the plan later. You will be asked what changed and why — that is a normal engineering answer, not a failure.